

AI and Automation Opportunity Tear Down

Purpose

This worksheet is designed to help you move from an interesting AI idea to a credible initiative. Work through it using a single AI opportunity that's relevant for your role.

In addition to strategic fit and feasibility, this version explicitly tests the business case for ethical AI adoption including reputational risk and staff engagement, as well as long-term sustainability.

Be concise. Write as if you were preparing for a senior leadership conversation.

Your opportunity

Working title:

In one sentence, what is the idea?

1. Problem clarity

Answer briefly and specifically:

- What exact problem does this address?
- Who experiences this problem most directly?
- What is the cost (time, risk, quality, money, trust) of leaving it unsolved for another year?
- If this problem disappeared tomorrow, who would notice?

Ethical lens

- Who might be negatively affected if this problem is solved badly or partially?
- Does solving this problem create new forms of potential discrimination or moral dilemmas?

2. What kind of AI is this, really?

- Which best describes the core role of AI here?
 - Content generation
 - Decision support
 - Workflow automation
 - Monitoring
 - Prediction
 - Other
- What would a **non-AI** solution look like?
- Why is that approach not sufficient?

Ethical lens

- What judgements or assumptions are embedded in this system?
- Where could bias, error or misplaced-trust arise?

3. Value and outcomes

Focus on outcomes, not features.

- **Objective** (what this ultimately supports).
- **Outcomes** (what would change if this works).
 - Outcome 1:
 - Outcome 2...

Ethical and organisational value

- How are we establishing trust with users and other stakeholders?
- How might it impact staff engagement or morale?
- If scrutinised externally, what would this initiative say about the organisation's values?
- How would you tell, in practice, that this is working and being used responsibly?

4. Impact on people and work

- Which tasks would change, reduce, or disappear?
- How are humans involved and what are they offering in terms of judgement and decision-making?

Ethical lens

- What new skills or support will staff need to work confidently with this system?
- How will you involve affected teams early enough to avoid disengagement or resistance?
- Where does human expertise remain essential?

6. Readiness, sustainability, and long-term fit

- What must already be true (data quality, governance, capability, permission, trust) for this to succeed?
- What is most likely to kill this in the first 90 days?

If you had to halve the scope, what would you keep and what would you drop?

Sustainability lens

- Does this initiative scale responsibly, or does risk increase faster than value?
- What ongoing oversight would be required?
- In three years would you still be comfortable defending this decision?

Why is this feasible and responsible now, not just theoretically?